Field Notes

Sunday, November 8, 2026
Boston · High 54° · Low 42°

IDEAS & LIFE

GREG ISENBERG @gregisenberg · Nov 7 IDEAS & LIFE

I think the coolest part of having kids is reliving your own childhood in a different way.

You remember what it felt like to be scared of the dark, to wait all year for a birthday or to think a cardboard box was the best toy in the world.

The difference is that now you're on the other side of it. And you get to be the person who makes those moments feel safe and magical.

You see the world through someone who's seeing it for the first time, and it makes you curious again.

I didn't expect parenting to make me feel younger on one hand, and older on the other but some days it does.

Highly recommend :)

Max Williamson @MaxXWilliamson · Nov 7 IDEAS & LIFE

Gotta love side project Saturdays: this time an O'Neill cylinder that actually looks like the future 🧵

VV @visualizevalue · Nov 8 IDEAS & LIFE

“Your whole idea about yourself is borrowed – borrowed from those who have no idea of who they are themselves.”

Daniel Colascione @dcolascione · Nov 7 IDEAS & LIFE

Lay people don't appreciate how much of post-1960s scholarship has been invalidated by ancient DNA, nor the extent to which it's vindicated earlier scholars, nor how generations have been mal-educated.

The post-60s errors are all in a single direction too: they interpret evidence through a model of human nature that predicts behaviors that run contrary to everyday intuition and observation. For example, for decades, dogma was that violence was rare until the bronze age. Of course, violence was, in fact, ubiquitous. Pots changed because people changed, not because (as scholars asserted with straight faces somehow) ideas diffused through word of mouth.

You can draw your own conclusions about why the academy pushed this model so hard, but it happened at exactly the same time the academy was pushing tons of other ideas inconsistent with an intuitive understanding of human nature.

Ancient DNA has made late 20th century revisionist historiography untenable, but other disciplines are still pushing related nonsense. All of it must be defunded and rebuilt.

> **Roman Helmet Guy** @romanhelmetguy
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> Wow, no one could have possibly predicted that late-20th century “historiography” would be less accurate than the ancient sources that they hate so much.

NATURE & HISTORY

Melancholy Yuga @MelancholyYuga · Nov 7 NATURE & HISTORY

The fact that the Romans administered the known world while mostly neglecting cartography in favor of verbal itineraries still freaks me out.

It's like they were playing blindfold chess with the entire Mediterranean.

> **LiorLefineder** @lefineder
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> The Vicarello Cups, 1st century AD.
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> Inscribed on them is the travel route that goes from Gades (Cádiz), Spain, overland to Rome, including all 104 stopping points along the way and the distances between them, for a total of 1,840 Roman miles.
>
> A stopping station each 17 miles is accommodating to daily travel distance on Roman roads.

LIGHTER

Justin Murphy @jmrphy · Nov 7 LIGHTER

Ancestry dot com has the best CTAs a business could ever dream of

“We may have found your great grandmother”

. . .

That’s all for today.

All posts are from X, quoted in full as posted. Six posts, November 2026. Compiled Sunday, Nov. 8, ET.